There are three main use cases for the app:

1. Following a route and getting audio instructions so you can have hands free direction.
2. Recording your track. You could record your tra

Designing a clean, frictionless user experience (UX) for a mapping and tracking application requires balancing **passive exploration**, **active tracking/navigation**, and **post-activity analysis**.

Unburdened by existing UI conventions, here is a recommended design structure focused on reducing cognitive load, maximizing map visibility, and matching user intent seamlessly.

1. The Core Philosophy: Map-First & Contextual Modes

The map should be the absolute center of the application. Instead of hiding functionality behind deep multi-layered menus, the interface should adapt dynamically based on what the user is currently doing (**Exploration**, **Navigation/Route Following**, **Free Tracking**, or **Playback**).

2. UI Layout Recommendations by Use Case

A. Initial Usage & Map Examination (Idle State)

When the user opens the app without an active route or tracking session, the UI should be minimal to let them focus entirely on the geography.

- **Full-Screen Map:** The map takes up 100% of the screen real estate.
- **Floating Search / Location Bar:** A top-floating pill bar for searching locations or centering on the user's current GPS position.
- **Bottom Action Drawer (Sheet):** A discreet bottom sheet or floating action button (FAB) offering clear primary paths: *"Start Free Track"* or *"Explore Routes"*. Tapping a pre-existing route on the map opens a preview card with an option to **"Edit Route"** (sub-goal) or **"Start Navigation"**.

B. Use Case 1: Route Following & Hands-Free Audio Guidance

When following a route, the user's eyes should remain up and out, not glued to the screen.

- **Distraction-Free Head-Up Display (HUD):**
  - At the top of the screen, display a single, large, high-contrast instruction card (e.g., *"Turn left in 50m onto Mountain Path"*).
  - Use clear audio cues for turns and milestone warnings, backed by optional subtle vibration patterns.
- **Control Bar:** A minimal bottom card showing remaining distance, estimated time to completion (ETA), and a prominent **"Finish / Save"** or **"Pause Route"** button.

C. Use Case 2: Free Track Recording (No Route)

When recording a track spontaneously without a planned path, the interface needs to emphasize ongoing metrics and safety.

- **Live Telemetry Banner:** A collapsible floating dashboard showing elapsed time, current speed, distance covered, and elevation gain.
- **Prominent State Control:** A clear, tactile primary control button (e.g., a central red/orange floating button) to **Pause**, **Resume**, or **Stop & Save Track**.

D. Use Case 3: Track Playback & Progress Analysis

After completing a route or track, users want to inspect how they performed over time and space.

- **Split-Screen Layout (Landscape/Tablet) or Stacked View (Phone):**
  - *Top Half:* The recorded track rendered on the map, potentially color-coded by a metric (e.g., green for fast speed, red for slow/breaks).
  - *Bottom Half:* Interactive synchronized charts or graphs (Elevation profile, Speed over time, Stride length distribution).
- **Scrubber Timeline:** A horizontal timeline slider at the bottom of the map. Dragging the scrubber moves a marker along the route path, allowing the user to step through their exact physical progress, speed spikes, and rest breaks frame-by-frame.

3. Navigation Architecture Recommendation

To tie these modes together smoothly without confusing the user:

1. **Persistent Bottom Navigation Bar (3 Tabs Max):**
   - **Explore (Map):** For map examination, searching, and selecting routes.
   - **Track / Navigate (Active State):** A dynamic tab that transforms or highlights whenever a route is active or tracking is live, ensuring the user can instantly jump back to their active guidance dashboard.
   - **History / Saved Tracks:** Where past recorded tracks live for playback and analysis.
2. **Contextual Overlays Over Static Menus:** Avoid complex hamburger menus. Actions like **"Edit Route"** should appear contextually when a route is selected in the Explore view, keeping editing tools out of the way until explicitly requested.